

Staff Recruitment, Vetting & Induction

COMPREHENSIVE POLICY — HIQA COMPLIANT

1 PURPOSE

To ensure all staff are recruited, vetted, and inducted in a safe, consistent, and legally compliant manner — protecting vulnerable adults and children, promoting transparent practices, and creating a competent workforce.

2 SCOPE

- ✓ Full-time, part-time, relief, and agency staff; volunteers and student placements
- ✓ Contractors or third-party providers with direct/indirect resident contact
- ✓ Management and HR staff involved in recruitment and onboarding

3 RECRUITMENT PRINCIPLES

- ✓ **Equal Opportunities:** Decisions on merit; no discrimination on age, gender, orientation, ethnicity, religion, disability
- ✓ **Role Clarity:** Defined job description, person spec, essential qualifications, safeguarding requirements
- ✓ **Transparent Process:** Shortlisting → structured interviews → competency assessment → reference/vetting checks
- ✓ **Safeguarding Priority:** All roles treated as positions of trust; concerns escalated immediately

4 SELECTION PROCESS

- ✓ **Shortlisting:** By ≥2 senior staff against job description; incomplete applications do not progress
- ✓ **Interview:** Panel of ≥2 (operational lead + HR); competency-based questions on values, safeguarding, experience, teamwork
- ✓ **Assessment:** Scenario tasks, written exercises, or shadowing for clinical/care roles
- ✓ **Conditional offer** pending: Garda vetting, reference checks, qualification verification



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GARDA VETTING, CONTRACTS & INDUCTION PROGRAMME

5 GARDA VETTING

- ✓ Processed under National Vetting Bureau (Children and Vulnerable Persons) Acts 2012–2016
- ✓ **Mandatory:** No staff/volunteer/contractor works with residents without completed clearance
- ✓ Exceptional conditional supervised duties only with senior management authorisation
- ✓ **Re-vetting:** Every 3 years, or on role change, safeguarding concern, or service break
- ✓ Disclosures reviewed by senior management; risk assessment before employment decision; securely stored

6 CONTRACTS & DECLARATIONS

- ✓ **Written contract:** Terms, hours, salary, probation, role description, grievance/disciplinary procedures — signed before first day
- ✓ **Code of Conduct:** Declaration confirming understanding of residents' rights, confidentiality, zero tolerance for abuse
- ✓ **Health & Character:** Declaration of fitness to work, no outstanding charges posing risk
- ✓ **GDPR:** Confidentiality agreement covering data storage, access, and breach consequences

7 INDUCTION PROGRAMME

- ✓ **Organisational:** Vision, mission, values, structure, governance
- ✓ **Service-specific:** Care setting, resident profiles, communication needs, HIQA compliance
- ✓ **Policy training:** Safeguarding, Medication Management, Incident Reporting, Fire Safety & Evacuation
- ✓ **Role-specific:** Job duties, supervision, manual handling, infection control, H&S
- ✓ **Supervised practice:** Minimum 5-day period; senior staff signs off core competencies before independent duties
- ✓ Induction checklist signed by staff member and supervisor; retained on file for audit

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PROBATION, TRAINING & ROTA TEMPLATES

8 PROBATION & SUPERVISION

- ✓ **6-month probation:** Monthly supervision meetings, resident/senior feedback, incident log review
- ✓ **Probation review:** Formal meeting — confirm permanent, extend with goals, or terminate; documented and signed
- ✓ **Ongoing supervision:** 1:1 every 6–8 weeks covering resident needs, staff wellbeing, training goals, safeguarding

9 TRAINING REGISTER

Mandatory Courses (All Staff):

Training	Frequency
Safeguarding Vulnerable Adults & Children	At induction + 2-year refresher
Manual Handling & Patient Moving	Annual
Fire Safety	Annual
Infection Prevention & Control	Annual
First Aid / CPR	Every 2 years
Medication Management	As applicable
GDPR & Data Protection	At induction + refresher
HIQA Standards & Regulations	At induction + refresher

Register maintained by HR/Compliance Officer; reviewed monthly; accessible for audits and HIQA inspections.

W WEEKLY ROTA TEMPLATE

Day	08:00–16:00	16:00–00:00	00:00–08:00 (Night)
Monday			
Tuesday			
Wednesday			
Thursday			
Friday			
Saturday			
Sunday			

Completed by: _____ Date: _____

Manager Signature: _____ Date: _____

Min Staff Ratio: _____ | On-Call Manager: _____ | Relief: _____